

I took Udacity Data Engineering with AWS Nanodegree, Feb 17 - May 17. These are my observations:

1. The content is good, but needs a major update.

Some AWS-related lessons look like draft versions of updates in progress, with outdated and updated paragraphs intersecting. This is disappointing because the “AWS” in the course title is the primary reason I purchased the course.

Those lessons are hard to follow, so challenging to learn from, and causes unnecessary unconstructive stress on top of the expected stress from learning.

You can find more details and specific examples in the page feedback I had been submitting via the “Give Page Feedback” option throughout the course.

2. The structure lacks uniformity and there are pages leaving you wondering.

Compare: Course 2, lesson 1.2 includes a video, written content, and a mini quiz, vs Course 2, lesson 2.5. where there's only a mini quiz with 2 questions.

Not a big deal, but it looks strange, and repeats throughout the course.

3. There are inconsistent and confusing instructions between lessons, which make it difficult to complete the tasks.

Example: Course 4, lesson 4.10 “Create a Spark Job ...” ends with asking to pick “Create a table in the Data Catalog...”, then moves to the lesson 4.11 where the instructor is working with “Do not update Catalog”. If you end up picking “Create a table...” at this point, you can't save your Job, and you may not understand why because they will only teach this later in the course, not in this lesson.

4. Some of the exercise solutions are not well written code, they're messy, have syntax errors, or deprecated operators. [Here's one example](#).

The course ratings have several issues:

Student Reviews

Average Rating: 4.6 Stars
1,248 Reviews



Daniel Bendel

★★★★☆

October 4, 2024

Was good. Sometimes lack of details

Lewis C

★★★★★

August 27, 2023

A great program to start up the Data Engineer career path specifically for Spark and AWS...

Navreen K.

★★★★★

April 12, 2023

It's a great learning for upskilling yourself.

Nicolas M.

★★★★☆

February 14, 2023

Once you get going, it gets really interesting and the topics are covered really well. Some issues with...
[Read More](#)

Prem Digdes M.

★★★★★

December 22, 2022

The program is really great and the hand on project provides a great understanding of the concepts...
[Read More](#)

←

Page 1 of 250

→

1. There are 0 ratings in 2025, even after I had graduated and submitted mine. There's 1 rating in 2024 and 3 in 2023. Is it possible that only 4 people took the course in 2 years?

2. Is it possible the ratings are filtered to only show the 4 and 5 stars? I couldn't find a rating lower than 4 stars. It's hard to believe that nobody found the course worth 3 stars. While searching for help on the [Knowledge](#) platform, I had come across quite a few upset messages from people, saying how they'll never do another Udacity course after this one. There were 2-3 years old messages from people upset about some problems that I'd still come across during the course.

3. I'd give it 3 stars, closer to 4, but not 4. After my graduation, I filled in the survey, but the only quantitative question I remember was "How likely are you to recommend...", on a scale 1-10. There was a qualitative question "How would you rate your satisfaction with Udacity?" which can be translated into 1-5 stars, where "satisfied" should be equal to 3, which was my choice.

4. It says that there are 1248 ratings on 250 pages.

Pages 1-226 show 5 ratings per page, that's 1130.

Page 227 shows 4 ratings, now that's 1134.

The page 227 content keeps repeating on the pages 228-250.

Student Reviews	Student Reviews
Average Rating: 4.6 Stars 1,248 Reviews ★★★★★	Average Rating: 4.6 Stars 1,248 Reviews ★★★★★
mazen o. ★★★★☆ April 13, 2020 It is really good, i wish if it is considering other Cloud services (GCP, Azure)	mazen o. ★★★★☆ April 13, 2020 It is really good, i wish if it is considering other Cloud services (GCP, Azure)
Ahmad C. ★★★★★ April 13, 2020 Love it. It's way beyond my expectations. From the code reviewing, to the peer chat, the exercises an... Read More	Ahmad C. ★★★★★ April 13, 2020 Love it. It's way beyond my expectations. From the code reviewing, to the peer chat, the exercises an... Read More
Asiye K. ★★★★★ April 13, 2020 The program is great. I am looking forward to see next chapters!!!	Asiye K. ★★★★★ April 13, 2020 The program is great. I am looking forward to see next chapters!!!
Dipan S. ★★★★★ April 13, 2020 Very well thought out program	Dipan S. ★★★★★ April 13, 2020 Very well thought out program
← Page 227 of 250 →	← Page 228 of 250 →

Where are the missing 114 ratings? Where's my rating?

Has this program helped me advance towards my professional and personal goals?
Absolutely.

Would I do another Udacity course?
Not sure that I would.

Would I discourage others from subscribing to Udacity Courses or Nanodegrees?
I'd encourage others to wait until this course gets updated.

Unemployed people buying it from their own pockets deserve it regularly maintained.
It takes so little for this course to deserve those 4.6/5 stars.